

AnalystLab Africa Consulting Project Execution Strategy

AI-Powered Customer Churn Prediction & Retention System: Tarrose Retail

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This report sets out how the AI-Powered Customer Churn Prediction & Retention System will move from an approved plan into execution: how the work will be run day to day, how progress and risk will be tracked, how the team will stay aligned, and how changes will be controlled. It should be read alongside the Project Schedule, Gantt Chart, Critical Path Analysis, Resource Allocation Plan and Project Budget.

1. How the Project Will Be Executed

Execution follows the predominantly predictive (Waterfall/PMBOK-aligned) methodology set out in the Project Charter, reflecting the project's fixed scope, budget and 20-week timeline. Work proceeds through the eight phases already baselined in the Project Schedule, each closing with a phase-gate review before the next begins:

Phase	Focus	Gate
1.0 Project Foundation	Charter, business case, requirements, objectives	Sponsor confirms scope & objectives
2.0 Project Plan	Schedule, resourcing, risk, communication, governance baselines	Sponsor approves baseline
3.0 Integrated Customer Data	POS, e-commerce & loyalty data unified into one customer view	Data quality validated
4.0 Churn Prediction Solution	Model build, validation, explainability	Sponsor approves model for use
5.0 Customer Intelligence Dashboard	Reporting layer for Marketing & Customer Service	UAT signed off
6.0 Retention Pilot	Segmentation, intervention design, control group, pilot	Pilot results evaluated
7.0 Operationalised Solution	Production deployment, monitoring & retraining set-up, handover	Compliance sign-off; handover accepted
8.0 Project Closure	Final evaluation, lessons learned, documentation, sign-off	Sponsor closes the project

Two work packages run iteratively inside this structure rather than as single linear tasks: Model Development (4.0) uses short test-and-adjust cycles typical of machine learning work, and the Dashboard (5.0) and Retention Pilot (6.0) branches are deliberately fast-tracked starting in parallel with the tail end of Model Development rather than waiting for it to finish which is what compresses the sequential 21-week network into the approved 20-week timeline. The Critical Path Analysis shows this parallel work carries no schedule risk of its own (20 and 11 days of float respectively), but it does mean the Data Integration → Model → Deployment → Closure chain must not slip, since every activity on it has zero float.

Each activity in the Project Schedule has a named Assigned Resource, so ownership is unambiguous from day one. The Project Manager runs weekly check-ins with the Data Engineer, Data Scientist and IT Lead to confirm activities are tracking to their baselined start and finish dates.

2. How Progress Will Be Monitored

Progress is tracked against the three baselines already established: the Project Schedule (dates), the Critical Path Analysis (float consumption), and the Project Budget (spend vs. the approved R1,000,000 ceiling).

Monitoring Activity	Frequency	Owner	Escalates To
Task status update (Asana)	Continuous / daily	Delivery Team	Project Manager
Schedule & critical-path variance review	Weekly	Project Manager	Sponsor (if critical path slips)
Budget-vs-actual review (Excel budget tracker)	Monthly	Project Manager	Finance; Sponsor
Phase-gate readiness review	At each phase gate	Project Manager	Sponsor (go/no-go decision)
Steering committee review	Monthly	Sponsor	Tarrose Retail Executive Committee

Because every activity on the critical path carries zero float, schedule monitoring focuses first on that chain, a one-day slip on any critical activity is a one-day slip on the 23-December completion date unless recovered. Non-critical branches (Dashboard, Retention Pilot) are monitored on a lighter cadence given their existing float.

3. How Project Risks Will Be Managed

Risk management follows the Risk Register established in Week 1, reviewed and updated at every phase gate and steering committee meeting rather than left static. Each risk retains its assigned owner, likelihood/impact score and mitigation, with particular attention to risks that sit on or near the critical path:

- Data integration risks (R1, R6) are reviewed at the close of Phase 3.0, before Model Development begins, since any unresolved data issue would delay every remaining critical activity.
- Model accuracy risk (R3) is reviewed at the 4.6 Model Approval gate — if the 75% accuracy target is at risk, the Sponsor is engaged immediately under the change-control process below.
- Internal capacity risk (R11) is reviewed from Week 15, ahead of the 7.4 Operational Handover, to arrange support if Tarrose Retail's internal team is not ready.
- Festive-season closure risk (R12) is tracked against the schedule buffer between 7.4 Handover / 8.0 Closure and the Week 19–20 office closure.

New risks identified during execution are logged within 48 hours, scored, assigned an owner, and reviewed at the next weekly check-in.

4. How Communication Will Be Maintained

Communication follows the structure defined in the Communication Plan: the Project Manager originates internal and task-level updates, while the Sponsor originates updates to the Tarrose Retail Executive Committee.

Communication	Audience	Frequency	Channel
Task & blocker updates	Delivery Team	Daily / continuous	Asana, team chat
Status report	Sponsor	Weekly	Email / meeting

Communication	Audience	Frequency	Channel
Budget report	Finance	Monthly	Excel budget tracker
Milestone update	All stakeholders	At each phase gate	Email
Steering committee	Sponsor, Executive Committee	Monthly + ad hoc go/no-go reviews	Meeting

Documentation of record, schedule, risk log, budget tracker is maintained in the shared GitHub repository and Excel logs described in the Communication Plan, so any stakeholder can check current status between scheduled updates.

5. How Project Changes Will Be Controlled

Change control follows the authority levels the Sponsor and Project Manager already agreed in the Project Charter, so execution does not require re-negotiating decision rights partway through the project.

Change Type	Authority	Process
Expenditure up to R25,000 per line item	Project Manager	Approved directly; logged in the budget tracker
Expenditure above R25,000	Sponsor	Routed through change control before spend
Minor scope clarification within the agreed WBS	Project Manager	Approved directly; WBS updated
Change affecting the 75% accuracy target, overall budget, or delivery date	Sponsor	Formal change control; Sponsor sign-off required
Contingency draw up to R20,000	Project Manager	Written justification logged in the budget tracker
Contingency draw above R20,000	Sponsor	Sponsor approval required before release
Funding beyond approved budget and contingency	Tarrose Retail Executive Committee	Routed through the Sponsor to the Executive Committee

Every change request regardless of size is logged with its rationale, cost/schedule impact, and approval status, keeping the change history auditable back to the original Charter and baseline schedule. Where a change affects a critical-path activity, the Project Manager confirms the resulting impact on the 23-December completion date before it is routed for approval.

Summary

Execution proceeds phase by phase against the baselined Project Schedule, with the critical path, running through Data Integration, Model Development, and Deployment/Closure as the primary focus of schedule monitoring. Risk, communication and change control all reuse the structures already approved in Week 1, so execution begins on a governance foundation the Sponsor has already signed off.